NORTHSTAR TECHNOLOGIES PVT. LTD.

IT Onboarding Procedures

Standard operating procedure for provisioning, securing, and handing over employee IT access and equipment

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INTERNAL TEAM PROCEDURE

This fictional demonstration SOP is prepared for Northstar Technologies Pvt. Ltd. and the OnBoardIQ platform. It is intended for internal process illustration and document-ingestion testing, not as an approved operational or security policy.

1. Purpose

This SOP defines the steps IT Operations follows to prepare and provision approved technology access and equipment for a new employee. It aims to ensure employees receive the tools required for their role while maintaining security, accountability, and a reliable audit trail.

- Prepare employee accounts, devices, and approved software before the joining date where practical.
- Grant access according to role, department, manager approval, and least-privilege principles.
- Verify that security controls are enabled before devices and accounts are handed over.
- Provide employees with initial instructions and a clear route for technical support.
- Record asset assignment, access provisioning, and completion status.

2. Scope and Applicability

This procedure applies to IT Operations personnel who provision accounts, devices, network access, collaboration tools, and approved business applications for new employees, interns, and other authorized joiners. HR and hiring managers provide the approved employee and role information needed to initiate the process.

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3. Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Human Resources	Create or confirm the employee onboarding record and provide verified joining details through the approved channel.
Hiring Manager	Confirm role, department, reporting line, required applications, access level, and any role-specific equipment.
IT Service Desk	Own the IT onboarding ticket, coordinate tasks, provision standard accounts, and maintain completion evidence.
IT Administrator	Configure identity, devices, endpoint security, network access, and approved application permissions.
Application Owner	Approve and provision access to the business application or system they manage.
New Employee	Complete required identity and security steps, protect credentials, and acknowledge receipt of assigned assets.

4. Initiation and Required Information

The IT onboarding process begins when HR or the hiring manager submits an approved onboarding request through the designated service desk or workflow system. IT should not create accounts based solely on an informal message.

- Employee full name and unique employee identifier.
- Joining date, employment type, location, and contact method for onboarding coordination.
- Department, job title, reporting manager, and role profile.
- Approved device requirements and any accessibility or ergonomic arrangements.
- Standard applications and any additional system access requested by the manager.
- Approver details for privileged, sensitive, or non-standard access.
- Confirmation that the employee record and hiring approval are complete.

If information is incomplete or inconsistent, IT should place the request in a pending state and ask HR or the manager to correct it. Do not guess an employee's department, role, or access requirements.

5. Standard Onboarding Workflow

Stage	IT activity	Completion evidence
1. Request validation	Review request completeness, approval, identity, role, and start date.	Validated onboarding ticket.
2. Account preparation	Create or schedule creation of the corporate identity and required accounts.	Account IDs and provisioning status recorded.
3. Device preparation	Select, configure, update, encrypt, and register assigned equipment.	Asset record and device compliance status.
4. Access assignment	Grant approved groups, applications, network access, and collaboration tools.	Access checklist and approval references.
5. Security verification	Confirm MFA, endpoint protection, encryption, and baseline settings.	Security checklist completed.
6. Handover	Provide device and access instructions to employee through secure channels.	Receipt acknowledgement and handover record.
7. Post-joining validation	Confirm sign-in, essential tools, and support route are working.	Ticket closure or tracked follow-up.

6. Identity and Account Provisioning

- Create the employee's corporate identity using the approved naming and identity lifecycle standards.
- Use a unique account identifier; do not reuse accounts belonging to former employees or contractors.
- Assign the employee to the correct organizational unit, department, and baseline access groups.
- Enable approved authentication controls, including multi-factor authentication where supported or required.
- Use temporary activation or first-login flows rather than sending permanent passwords in plain text.
- Require the employee to establish their own authentication secret using the approved identity workflow.
- Do not share credentials between employees or use generic accounts for routine individual work.
- Record the account owner, creation date, requested access, approver, and provisioning status.

7. Device Preparation and Asset Assignment

Devices must be prepared using the approved endpoint build and asset-management process before they are issued to an employee.

- Select a standard laptop or workstation based on the role profile and approved requirements.
- Record asset tag, serial number, model, assigned user, condition, and issue date.
- Install supported operating system updates and approved endpoint management software.
- Enable full-disk encryption, endpoint protection, screen lock, and required security baselines.
- Configure approved network, Wi-Fi, VPN, and device compliance settings as applicable.
- Install only licensed and approved software required for the employee's role.
- Remove default accounts, unnecessary applications, and insecure factory settings.
- Provide approved peripherals and record each assigned item.
- Do not issue a device that fails required security or compliance checks without documented exception approval.

8. Application, Network, and Data Access

Access must be provisioned according to verified job responsibilities and documented approvals. The employee's department or job title alone does not authorize access to every system used by that team.

- Start with the approved baseline access profile for the role.

- Grant additional application access only after the relevant manager or application owner approves the request.
- Use role-based groups rather than ad hoc individual permissions wherever practical.
- Apply least privilege and avoid granting administrator rights for convenience.
- Restrict access to production systems, sensitive datasets, financial systems, and HR records to explicitly authorized users.
- Use separate privileged accounts or approved elevation workflows for administrative tasks.
- Record access granted, group membership, approval reference, and provisioning date.
- Do not share API keys, database passwords, service credentials, or privileged tokens with new employees through ordinary chat or email.

9. Security Verification Before Handover

Control	Verification
Identity	Employee identity and account ownership match the approved onboarding request.
MFA	Multi-factor authentication is enabled or enrolment is scheduled through the approved process.
Device encryption	Full-disk encryption is active and recovery information is managed securely.
Endpoint protection	Approved endpoint protection and device management are active and reporting.
Updates	Required operating system and application updates are installed.
Screen lock	Automatic screen locking and approved authentication settings are configured.
Access scope	Application and network permissions match documented approvals.
Asset record	Device and accessory assignments are recorded against the employee.

10. Employee Handover and First-Day Support

- Confirm the employee has received the assigned device and required accessories.
- Provide sign-in instructions through an approved secure channel.
- Guide the employee through first sign-in, MFA enrolment, password setup, and recovery options.
- Explain how to connect to approved collaboration tools, network resources, and support channels.
- Provide basic guidance on phishing reporting, device security, software installation, and safe data handling.
- Confirm that the employee can access the standard tools required for their role.
- Record employee acknowledgement of equipment receipt and applicable acceptable-use requirements.
- Do not ask the employee to disclose their password or MFA code to IT staff.

11. Non-Standard and Privileged Access

Requests for elevated or non-standard access require a documented business justification and approval from the appropriate system owner or authorized manager.

- Identify the exact system, permission level, business purpose, and required duration.
- Prefer time-limited access and approved privileged-access workflows.
- Require additional security review for production, infrastructure, source-code administration, and sensitive data access.
- Record approver, access start date, expiry or review date, and responsible system owner.
- Verify that temporary access is removed when its approved period ends or the business need ceases.

12. Delays, Exceptions, and Escalation

- If a device is unavailable, coordinate an approved temporary device or revised joining arrangement with the hiring manager.

- If an account or application is unavailable, record the blocker and provide an estimated resolution through the approved channel.
- Escalate missing approvals, identity mismatches, suspicious requests, or unexpected privilege requirements to the relevant owner.
- Document security exceptions with business justification, risk assessment, approver, compensating controls, and expiry date.
- Do not bypass identity checks, security baselines, or authorization requirements to meet a joining deadline.

13. Post-Joining Validation and Ticket Closure

- Confirm successful sign-in and access to required standard applications.
- Check device compliance and confirm endpoint management is reporting correctly.
- Confirm any outstanding access request has an owner and target date.
- Update the onboarding ticket with completion evidence and unresolved items.
- Close the ticket only when required tasks are complete or formally transferred to an accountable owner.
- Retain records according to the approved IT service and asset-management retention schedule.

14. Records and Confidentiality

- Store onboarding requests, approvals, asset records, and provisioning evidence in approved IT systems.
- Limit access to onboarding records to personnel with a legitimate operational need.
- Do not include passwords, MFA codes, private keys, or recovery secrets in tickets or handover notes.
- Use secure channels for identity documents and personal information; avoid unnecessary copies.
- Maintain an audit trail for account creation, access grants, privileged changes, and asset handover.
- Report suspected unauthorized access or data disclosure through the incident response process.

15. Operational Checklist

Checkpoint	Required evidence
Request received	Approved onboarding request with verified employee and role details.
Role confirmed	Department, manager, job title, and access profile validated.
Accounts ready	Corporate identity and baseline accounts provisioned.
Device ready	Managed, updated, encrypted, protected, and asset-tagged device.
Access approved	Application and network permissions approved and recorded.
Security checked	MFA, endpoint protection, encryption, and baseline settings verified.
Handover complete	Employee receives instructions and acknowledges assigned assets.
Ticket closed	Completion evidence saved; outstanding work assigned and tracked.

16. Roles, Ownership, and Review

The IT Operations Team owns this SOP and is responsible for maintaining the onboarding checklist, coordinating process updates, and ensuring that IT provisioning records are retained in approved systems. HR and hiring managers are responsible for providing accurate, approved employee information and access requirements.

This SOP should be reviewed periodically and whenever identity systems, device-management standards, access governance, or onboarding workflows materially change. Changes must be approved by the designated IT process owner before publication.

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